

Tutorial 1 Project Management Concept

Question 1

Differentiate between a software project and a construction project by completing Table 1 below. Include an example in each of your answers.

Table 1: Comparison of software project and construction project

	Software Project (example: developing the Exam Timetable System)	Construction Project (example: building a bridge)
Invisibility		
Flexibility		

Question 2

T-Shirts2U is a small company that supplies and manufactures customized t-shirts. However, its current system, which is partially automated, is unable to keep track of the orders and stocks efficiently. Besides that, it is unable to provide accurate information to the management on which items are more profitable, and there have been mistakes in some of the order fulfillments. In order to solve these problems, the senior management of T-Shirts2U has requested you to develop a new online ordering system to increase the company's annual sales by RM50,000. The new system to be developed has the following modules: Customer, Order carts, Online payment, and Order fulfillment. This project must be completed within 3 months with an allocated budget of RM180,000. The project team consists of six software developers.

- Identify and explain TWO (2) constraints of the T-shirt2U project implementation. Explain your answer.
- The outcome of a project can be classified as truly successful, partially successful, or a total failure. Hence, the new online ordering system project can be considered as a total failure if _____.
(Complete the above sentence)

Question 3

Return on Investment (ROI), Net Present Value (NPV) and many other financial techniques can be used to evaluate and compare the risks and rewards of different projects. They help project managers to decide whether a project is worthwhile to pursue or not. Table 1 illustrates the cash flow of Project ABC. The cash flow takes place at the end of each year.

Table 1: Cash flow of Project ABC

Year	Project X
0	-50,000
1	20,000
2	20,000
3	20,000
4	30,000

Using a 12% discount rate, calculate the Net Present Value (NVP) and Return on Investment (ROI) for this Project. Based on your calculations, analyse whether the project is attractive or should be rejected. Explain your answer.

Note:

- Show your workings in the calculation.
- Negative values represent costs.
- Discount factors round up to 4 decimal points. All other figures round up to the nearest integer.
- ROI in percentage, rounds up to 2 decimal points.

Question 4

Using a 10% discount rate, calculate the Net Present Value (NPV) and Return on Investment (ROI) for Project X and Project Y. Based on your calculations, suggest the most profitable project. Explain your answer.

Show your calculation to justify your answer. Discount factors round up to 4 decimal points.

Discount Rate: 10% for both projects					
Project X	Year 0	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Costs	100,000	50,000	40,000	30,000	-
Discount Factor	1				
Discounted Costs	100,000				
Benefits	0	100,000	120,000	100,000	-
Discount Factor	1				
Discounted Benefits	0				
NPV					
ROI:					
Use discounted value					

Project Y	Year 0	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Total
Costs	100,000	70,000	60,000	20,000	-
Discount Factor	1				
Discounted Costs	100,000				
Benefits	0	100,000	150,000	90,000	-
Discount Factor	1				
Discounted Benefits	0				
NPV					
ROI:					

Comment:

Question 5

ABC Tech Company provides software consultancy services to business clients. It focuses on selling accounting software. The company consists of 4 different departments: sales and marketing, customer services, information technology (IT), and finance. Each staff member will be assigned to a department according to his or her area of specialization and expertise. The sales and marketing department consists of 3 staff, 2 staff work in the customer service department, while 3 staff work in the finance department, and 3 experienced staff work in the IT department. Each department is supervised by a functional manager, and each functional manager in turn reports to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

- Draw the organization structure of this company.
- Based on part a), explain TWO (2) advantages of this organizational structure.

Question 6

You are a project manager of an online education management system (EMS) developed for a private college. After communicating with the staff for collecting requirements, the following scope is defined: the system will be used to manage communication between lecturers and students, uploading and downloading learning materials (such as tutorial questions, lecture notes, assignments specifications), making announcements, and assessing students' assignments. The modules of EMS can be modularized with a well-defined scope and high staff involvement. The project team focuses on the core features of the user interface design, assessment, communication, announcement, and submission. A budget of RM150,000 has been approved for the project with a duration of 8 weeks.

Construct a *Work Breakdown Structure* (WBS) for the online education management system using an outline numbering format. Assume that you have chosen the *Waterfall software process model*.

Tutorial 2: Project Planning, Control, and Process Models

Question 1

Case Study: Beamscope Canada, Inc.

Beamscope Canada, Inc. is an electronics distributor located in Scarborough, Ontario. In their manual order processing system, when a customer called to place an order, the clerk would scribble it down, run down the hall to the credit check guys, and flip through files and folders to see if their credit was okay. The clerk would then run to see whether Beamscope actually had the item in stock and then go back to the telephone to confirm the order. There were two PCs at the company and they were doing \$93 million worth of business. The phone orders were manually routed to the warehouse, where they would sit for at least a week. Plus, it was hard to know what was actually in the warehouse and where it was. It took Beamscope five to seven days to ship an order, and very often, there were mistakes made with the orders. In addition, products were collecting dust at Beamscope's physical warehouses. It also took a long time to compile reports for senior management and by the time the reports were printed, the information was already outdated. Senior management at Beamscope envisioned a new system that not only takes on order entry but also features a radio frequency bar-code system for inventory control, electronic data interchange and a data warehouse for decision support. In the new system, customers can place orders themselves, check the status of previous orders and download product literature. If an item is temporarily out of stock, the system will suggest a substitute or put the customer on a list for back orders. The system will also allow users to browse 120,000 square feet of shelves holding 10,500 different products in the company's 2 warehouses. In addition, the new system is directly tied into United Parcel Service, Inc.'s electronic shipping system.

- a) Well-defined objectives should be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time- constrained (SMART). Evaluate the following project objective: *To develop a new enterprise system that is faster and more user-friendly by the end of next year.*
 - (i) Analyze which elements of the SMART criteria this objective fails to meet?
 - (ii) Propose a revised version that meets all the SMART criteria.
- b) Identify and describe TWO (2) stakeholders of the Beamscope project.

Question 2

A network diagram can be used to illustrate the interdependencies between tasks in a project. Table 1 shows the project tasks, duration, and its predecessor.

Task ID	Task Name	Duration (in weeks)	Predecessor
A	Collect requirements	1	None
B	Design online module	1	A
C	Code online module	2	B
D	Design offline module	1	A
E	Code offline module	1	D
F	Testing the online and offline module	2	C, E

- a) Create a network diagram based on information provided in Table 1.
- b) Based on the answer given in part a), identify the critical path based on the task ID and specify the total duration needed to complete the project.

Question 3

Gantt charts are used to illustrate the sequence of activities in a project. Figure 1 is an example of a Gantt chart. Redraw the Gantt chart in Figure 1 using the predecessor information provided in Table 1 to illustrate the interdependencies between project activities. Assuming the project starts in June 2024.

Figure 1: Example of a Gantt chart

Task ID	Task Name	Jun '24	Jul '24	Aug '24	Sep '24	Oct '24
1	Analyse Requirements	■				
2	Design online module	■				
3	Code online module	■	■			
4	Design offline module	■				
5	Code offline module	■				
6	Test online and offline module	■	■			

Table 1: Project activity and its predecessor

Task ID	Task Name	Duration (in month)	Predecessor
1	Analyze requirements	1	None
2	Design online module	1	1
3	Code online module	1.5	2
4	Design offline module	1	1
5	Code offline module	1	4
6	Testing online and offline module	1.5	3, 5

Identify the month for the **Task ID 6** will be completed.

Question 4

Given the following information in Table 1 below:

Table 1: Status of Project A

(Refer to Appendix 2.2)

Activity	Estimated Duration (month)	Estimated Cost (RM)	Status	Earned Value (EV)
A	1	20,000	50%	
B	3	20,000	80%	
C	2	30,000	80%	
D	4	40,000	70%	
E	4	45,000	60%	
F	4	25,000	0%	
G	2	20,000	0%	
Total	20	200,000	-	

Assume that project A is now in its **10th** month. As of today, you have paid out RM 103,000 to the contractors. Contractors are those who performed the tasks shown in Table 1. The budget at completion for project A is RM200,000. Show the workings in your calculation.

a) Calculate the following values based on information provided in Table 1:

- Planned Value (PV)
- Earned Value (EV)
- Schedule Variance (SV)
- Cost Variance (CV)

Based on the calculated results, provide comments with an analysis on the performance of this project.

- b) Based on the results calculated in part a), explain ONE (1) corrective action to ensure the project's success.

Question 5

Your project team has been assigned to handle the Beamscope's project, duration is 24-months with a high-budget project. The user requirements for the system are still uncertain but the company has committed to a few departmental managers to be highly involved and provide consultation for this project. In addition, the scale of the project is large and it entails the use of a new technology and programming language that your team is unfamiliar with.

Consider which software process model you would propose for the above project: *Rapid Application Development* or the *Spiral model*? Explain your answer.

Tutorial 3: Quality Management & Assurance

Question 1

Refer to the case study in Tutorial 2 Question 1 (Beamscope company),
Suggest **ONE (1)** *software quality attribute* for Beamscope's project implementation. Explain your answer.

(Refer also to Appendix 3.1)

Question 2

Quality Assurance (QA) and Quality Control (QC) are important activities in software quality management. Identify and explain **THREE (3)** differences between Quality Assurance (QA) and Quality Control (QC) in software development.

Question 3

Errors and defects found in software will reduce the software quality. However, there are many techniques to avoid errors and defects in software projects. Below are the two of them:

- Inspections
- Lessons learnt report

Describe the two above techniques.

Question 4

The president of ABC College has recently assigned you to manage a new project that is to develop an Access Card Control System for enhancing the security in the campus. For implementing this system, the quality of the software is as important as the quality of hardware such as RFID devices. In order to produce good quality software, it is necessary to perform quality management activities. However, performing quality management activities will incur costs.

Describe 3 categories of quality costs as given below:

- Prevention costs
- Appraisal costs
- Failure costs

Explain which category is likely to be *most costly* to the ABC College. Justify your answer.

Tutorial 4: Software Metrics

Question 1

Table 1 shows the size-oriented metrics of Project teams A & B.

Table 1: Size-oriented metric of Project Team A and Team B

	Non normalised		Normalised with KLOC	
	Team A	Team B	Team A	Team B
Programming languages used	Java	Php	Java	Php
Total Lines of Code (LOC)	306,000	256,000		
Errors	288	233		
Defects	30	20		
Pages of Documentation	205	180		

Normalised the metrics of project team A and project team B with KLOC (thousand lines of code). Using the normalised metrics, compare the *quality* of both projects. Provide comments with an analysis of both projects.

Note:

- Provide your answers for the last 2 columns of Table 1.
- Show your workings, round up your answer to 4 decimal points.

Question 2

For **a) and b)**, show the workings in your calculation. Round up your answer to two decimal places.

a) Referring to Table 1, calculate the *function points (FP)* for both projects.

FP formula: $\text{Count Total} \times [0.65 + 0.01 \sum F_i]$

Table 1: Information domain values of Project A and B

Measurement parameters	Weighting factor	Project A's Count	Project B's Count
Number of inputs	Complex (5)	4	4
Number of outputs	Simple (2)	6	5
Number of inquiries	Average (4)	8	8
Number of files	Average (3)	4	2
Number of external interfaces	Simple (2)	2	1
The adjustment values $\sum F_i$ for both projects		50	40

Table 2: Defects found and documentation of Project A and B

	Project A's Count	Project B's Count
Defects	90	70
Pages of documentation	120	130

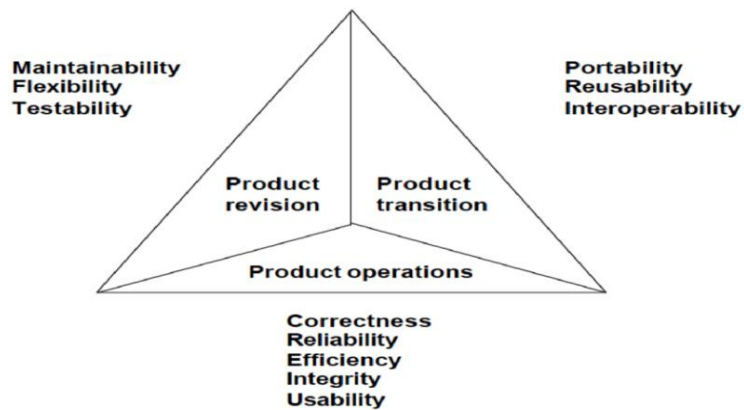
b) Referring to Table 2, calculate the defects and pages of documentation per function point. Comments which project has *higher maintainability* based on the calculated result.

Question 3

McCall's Software Quality Factor model is used to evaluate the quality of software products.

a) Describe the following categories

- Product Operation, Product Revision and Product Transition.



Refer to Appendix 4.1,
software quality attributes in
each category

b) Refer to the case study in Tutorial 1 Question 2 (T-shirt2U company).

Explain ONE (1) quality attribute applicable to the T-shirt2U's new ordering system and provide ONE (1) metric for measuring it.

Question 4

Identify and explain TWO (2) characteristics of good metrics to measure the quality attributes of the system.

Tutorial 5: Risk Management

The risk categories are product size (PS), business impact (BU), process definition (PR), customer characteristics (CU), development environment (DE), technology to be built (TE), and staff size and experience (ST).
Risk mitigation, monitoring, and management (RMMM) actions

Risk management strategy is considered as risk acceptance, risk avoidance, risk reduction, risk mitigation, or risk transfer.

Question 1

The risk projection shows the following information:

60 reusable software components were planned. 42 components can be reused, and 18 new components would have to be developed from scratch to meet new requirements.

Risk identified: 18 components have to be custom-developed to meet new requirements. The average component is 100 lines of code (LOC), and the cost for each LOC is RM14.00.

Risk probability: 50%

Calculate the following values using Halstead's risk exposure metric (probability X cost):

- Cost to develop the 18 software components.
- Risk exposure

Question 2

Project risks can be dealt with by using a reactive risk strategy or a proactive risk strategy. Explain the *reactive risk strategy*, then give an example to highlight why it is a bad strategy.

Question 3

Consider the following potential risks in Table 1

Table 1: Project risk, category, probability, and impact

No.	Risks	Category	Probability of Occurrence (0-1)	*Impact on the project (1-4)	Risk Score
1	Unstable database	TE	0.5	3	
2	Inadequate software architecture	PR	0.3	2	
3	Staff turnover in the project team	ST	0.6	4	
4	Resistance to use the system	CU	0.1	2	

*Impact values: 1 – negligible 2 – marginal 3 – critical 4 – catastrophic

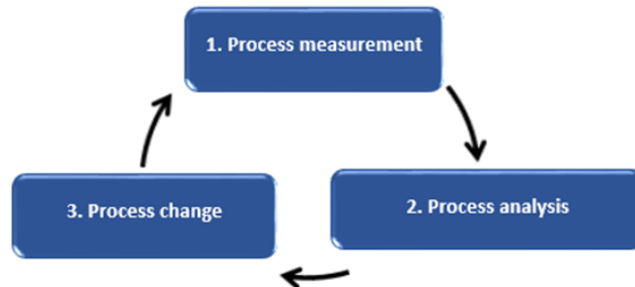
- Calculate the risk score for each risk listed in table 1, *rank the risks* according to their priority *using risk no* (i.e., from highest to lowest risk score). Show the workings in your calculation.
- Identify ONE (1) risk with the **highest** risk score in part a). Propose suitable *risk mitigation* and *monitoring actions* for the identified risk. Explain your answer.

Tutorial 6: Software Process Improvement

Question 1

Figure 1 illustrates a 3-stage generic framework for improving Software Development Process. Identify THREE (3) types of process metric that you would consider gathering at the beginning of the 3-stage model shown in Figure 1. Provide an example for each of your answers.

Figure 1: Software Process Improvement Cycle

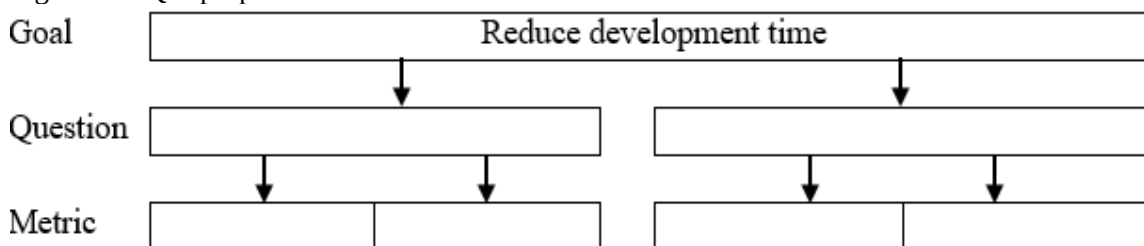


Question 2

You are measuring a software process to solve an issue, which is to *reduce development time* from a programmer's perspective. It was found that software development time always takes longer than planned. 2 main areas that might contribute to the issue are: the time required to collect system requirements with customers and requirement changes. You have identified the metrics in measuring these 2 areas, which are time taken for communication with the customer, the number of communications with the customer, and pages of requirement documentation. On the other hand, the top management does not agree with your findings and thus will not support your software improvement process (SPI) efforts financially. Seeing that the top management is not supportive, your colleagues appeared less cooperative in giving their feedback when you tried to collect the data for process analysis.

a) Using the GQM paradigm, suggest suitable **Questions and Metrics** for the given goal in Figure 2.

Figure 2: GQM proposal



b) Given below are two difficulties that may arise during the **process change** stage:

- Resistance to change
- Change Persistence

Explain each of these difficulties.

Question 3

Refer to the case study in Tutorial 1 Question 3,

Describe TWO (2) techniques used in the process analysis stage to improve the software development process for the T-Shirt 2U's project.

Tutorial 7: Software Configuration Management

Question 1

In the context of version management, identify and explain TWO (2) features of Distributed Version Control and Centralized Version Control Systems in software development.

Question 2

System release is a crucial phase in the software development lifecycle where the developed software is made available to users. Describe TWO (2) factors that influence system release planning.

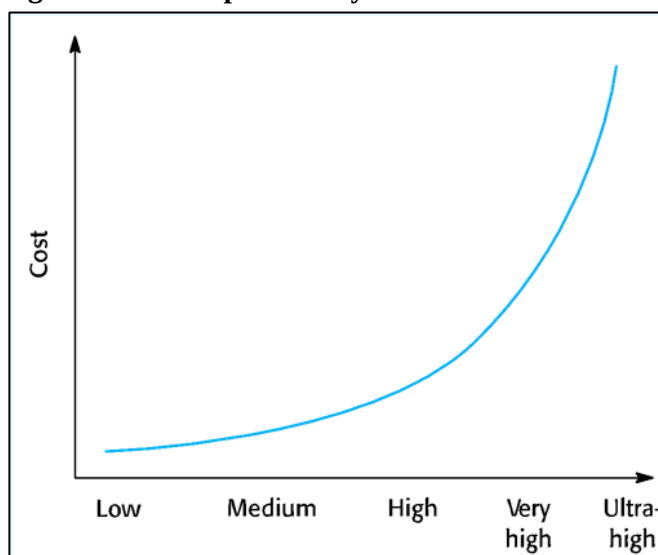
Question 3

One of the change management activities is to approve the change requests from stakeholders. Discuss ONE(1) factor in change analysis that influences whether the change request should be approved or not.

Tutorial 8: System Dependability and Critical Systems

- a) In the context of System Dependability, describe the concept of Availability, Reliability, and Resilience.
- b) With reference to the Cost/Dependability Curve in Figure 3, explain **TWO (2)** specific reasons why the cost of development increases exponentially as the required level of dependability approaches “Ultra-high”.

Figure 3: Cost/Dependability Curve



- c) A commercial bank is upgrading its mobile banking app. Evaluate whether this app should be classified as Safety-critical or Business-critical system. Justify your choice by comparing the consequences of failure for each type.

- end -